

Power Lunch: 20 High-Protein Recipes for Busy Days

*(Approximate nutrition per serving — every recipe has 12g+ protein)
Quick to make, easy to batch-cook, and lunchbox-friendly*

1. Rajma Chawal Bowl

Calories: 320 | **Protein:** 14g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 50g

Ingredients: - 1 cup boiled rajma (kidney beans) - Onion-tomato masala base, cumin, garam masala - 3/4 cup cooked rice

Procedure: Sauté onion-tomato masala with cumin and garam masala, add boiled rajma and simmer 10 minutes with a little water. Serve over rice. Cook the rajma the night before to save time.

2. Chana Masala with Brown Rice

Calories: 310 | **Protein:** 13g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 48g

Ingredients: - 1 cup boiled chickpeas - Onion-tomato masala, ginger-garlic, chana masala powder - 3/4 cup cooked brown rice

Procedure: Cook onion-tomato masala with ginger-garlic and chana masala powder, add chickpeas and simmer 10 minutes. Serve with brown rice. Batch-cook the chana for 3-4 lunches at once.

3. Paneer Tikka Masala with Quinoa

Calories: 350 | **Protein:** 18g | **Fat:** 14g | **Carbs:** 30g

Ingredients: - 150g paneer, cubed and pan-grilled - Tomato-based curry, mild spices - 3/4 cup cooked quinoa

Procedure: Pan-grill marinated paneer cubes until lightly charred. Simmer in a tomato-based curry for 8-10 minutes. Serve over cooked quinoa.

4. Soya Chunk Curry with Multigrain Roti

Calories: 300 | **Protein:** 20g | **Fat:** 8g | **Carbs:** 32g

Ingredients: - 1 cup soaked soya chunks - Onion-tomato gravy, spices - 2 multigrain rotis

Procedure: Squeeze out water from soaked soya chunks. Simmer in onion-tomato gravy with spices for 10 minutes until soft. Serve with warm multigrain roti. One of the highest-protein options in this book.

5. Egg Curry with Brown Rice

Calories: 320 | **Protein:** 16g | **Fat:** 12g | **Carbs:** 34g

Ingredients: - 2 boiled eggs, halved - Onion-tomato gravy, curry spices - 3/4 cup cooked brown rice

Procedure: Simmer boiled eggs in a lightly spiced onion-tomato gravy for 5-7 minutes. Serve with brown rice.

Vegetarian Swap: Replace eggs with 1 cup boiled mixed sprouts, simmered in the same gravy for 8-10 minutes until softened.

Calories: 290 | **Protein:** 13g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 42g

6. Paneer & Vegetable Pulao

Calories: 340 | **Protein:** 15g | **Fat:** 12g | **Carbs:** 40g

Ingredients: - 100g paneer, cubed - Mixed vegetables, whole spices - 3/4 cup rice

Procedure: Sauté whole spices, add vegetables and paneer, then rice and water. Cook covered until rice is done. A one-pot meal that's easy to pack straight from the pan.

7. Moong Dal Tadka with Jeera Rice

Calories: 300 | **Protein:** 14g | **Fat:** 7g | **Carbs:** 44g

Ingredients: - 3/4 cup cooked yellow moong dal - Tadka of cumin, garlic, dried red chili - 3/4 cup jeera (cumin) rice

Procedure: Cook dal until soft. Prepare a hot tadka of cumin, garlic and red chili in ghee, pour over dal. Serve with jeera rice.

8. Chickpea & Vegetable Wrap

Calories: 310 | **Protein:** 13g | **Fat:** 8g | **Carbs:** 40g

Ingredients: - 1 cup boiled chickpeas, lightly mashed - Chopped vegetables, mint-yogurt sauce - 1 whole wheat wrap/tortilla

Procedure: Mix mashed chickpeas with chopped vegetables and a spoon of mint-yogurt sauce. Roll into a whole wheat wrap. Ready to assemble in under 10 minutes.

9. Tofu Bhurji with Multigrain Roti

Calories: 280 | **Protein:** 16g | **Fat:** 10g | **Carbs:** 26g

Ingredients: - 150g tofu, crumbled - Chopped onion, tomato, turmeric, spices - 2 multigrain rotis

Procedure: Sauté onion and tomato with turmeric and spices, add crumbled tofu and cook 5 minutes. Serve with multigrain roti.

10. Kadai Paneer with Brown Rice

Calories: 350 | **Protein:** 17g | **Fat:** 15g | **Carbs:** 32g

Ingredients: - 120g paneer, cubed - Capsicum, onion, kadai masala - 3/4 cup cooked brown rice

Procedure: Sauté capsicum and onion with kadai masala, add paneer and toss for 5 minutes. Serve with brown rice.

11. Lobia (Black-Eyed Bean) & Vegetable Bowl

Calories: 260 | **Protein:** 13g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 34g

Ingredients: - 3/4 cup boiled lobia (black-eyed beans) - Chopped cucumber, tomato, onion - Lemon juice, roasted cumin powder, coriander

Procedure: Mix boiled lobia with chopped vegetables, lemon juice, roasted cumin powder and coriander. A cold, no-reheat bowl that's easy to pack the night before.

12. Protein-Boosted Egg Fried Rice

Calories: 340 | **Protein:** 18g | **Fat:** 12g | **Carbs:** 38g

Ingredients: - 2 eggs, scrambled - 3/4 cup cooked rice - Mixed vegetables, soy sauce (low sodium), spring onion

Procedure: Scramble eggs and set aside. Stir-fry vegetables, add rice and soy sauce, toss well, then fold in scrambled eggs. Ready in 15 minutes.

Vegetarian Swap: Replace scrambled eggs with 3/4 cup boiled mixed sprouts, sautéed along with the vegetables before adding rice.

Calories: 310 | **Protein:** 14g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 46g

13. Palak Paneer with Roti

Calories: 320 | **Protein:** 16g | **Fat:** 14g | **Carbs:** 26g

Ingredients: - 120g paneer, cubed - 1.5 cups pureed spinach (palak) - Garlic, cumin, mild spices - 2 multigrain rotis

Procedure: Sauté garlic and cumin, add pureed spinach and simmer 5 minutes. Add paneer cubes and cook 3-4 minutes more. Serve with roti.

14. Mixed Dal & Vegetable Power Soup

Calories: 240 | **Protein:** 14g | **Fat:** 5g | **Carbs:** 30g

Ingredients: - 1/2 cup mixed dals (moong, masoor, toor) - Mixed vegetables, cumin, garlic - Coriander for garnish

Procedure: Pressure-cook mixed dals with vegetables, cumin and garlic until soft. Blend lightly for a thicker soup, or serve as-is. A warming, filling one-bowl lunch.

15. Grilled Chicken & Vegetable Wrap

Calories: 320 | **Protein:** 24g | **Fat:** 8g | **Carbs:** 30g

Ingredients: - 100g chicken breast, grilled and sliced - Chopped vegetables, mint-yogurt sauce - 1 whole wheat wrap/tortilla

Procedure: Marinate and pan-grill chicken breast until cooked through, slice thin. Fill a whole wheat wrap with chicken, vegetables and mint-yogurt sauce. The highest-protein option in this book.

Vegetarian Swap: Replace chicken with 120g paneer or 120g tofu, marinated the same way and pan-grilled until lightly charred.

Calories: 300 | **Protein:** 17g | **Fat:** 12g | **Carbs:** 30g

16. Chana Bhurji Wrap

Calories: 290 | **Protein:** 13g | **Fat:** 7g | **Carbs:** 38g

Ingredients: - 1 cup boiled chickpeas, coarsely mashed - Chopped onion, tomato, spices - 1 whole wheat wrap/tortilla

Procedure: Sauté onion and tomato with spices, add mashed chickpeas and cook 5 minutes like a bhurji. Roll into a whole wheat wrap.

17. Quinoa & Chickpea Salad Bowl

Calories: 300 | **Protein:** 13g | **Fat:** 9g | **Carbs:** 36g

Ingredients: - 3/4 cup cooked quinoa - 1/2 cup boiled chickpeas - Chopped cucumber, tomato, lemon-olive oil dressing

Procedure: Mix cooked quinoa and chickpeas with chopped vegetables. Toss with a simple lemon-olive oil dressing. Serve cold — great for meal prep.

18. Dal Makhani with Brown Rice

Calories: 330 | **Protein:** 15g | **Fat:** 10g | **Carbs:** 42g

Ingredients: - 3/4 cup boiled whole urad dal & rajma mix - Tomato puree, light cream or curd, mild spices - 3/4 cup cooked brown rice

Procedure: Simmer boiled dal-rajma mix with tomato puree and spices for 15 minutes, finish with a spoon of curd or light cream. Serve with brown rice.

19. Chole with Multigrain Roti

Calories: 310 | **Protein:** 13g | **Fat:** 8g | **Carbs:** 40g

Ingredients: - 1 cup boiled chickpeas - Chole masala, onion-tomato gravy - 2 multigrain rotis

Procedure: Cook onion-tomato gravy with chole masala, add boiled chickpeas and simmer 10-12 minutes. Serve with multigrain roti.

20. Mixed Sprouts Usal

Calories: 260 | **Protein:** 15g | **Fat:** 6g | **Carbs:** 32g

Ingredients: - 1.5 cups mixed sprouts (moth, moong, chickpea) -
Onion-tomato masala, goda masala or garam masala - Coriander,
lemon

Procedure: Sauté onion-tomato masala with spices, add mixed sprouts and a little water, and simmer 10 minutes until tender. Finish with coriander and lemon. A Maharashtrian-style protein-packed curry, light enough to eat on its own.

Note: Nutrition values are approximate estimates and may vary based on exact quantities and brands used. Recommend a nutrition-calculation review before final print if precision is important for clinical credibility.